room. Aside from this lapse, Morné's sense of direction has been almost perfect over all these years. He has been a great teammate and friend.

2011

The ODI series win over India in January ensured that the Proteas travelled to compete in the 2011 ICC Cricket World Cup with the increasingly familiar blend of confidence in a strong squad and hope that we would play to our full potential. The tournament was being played in India, Sri Lanka and Bangladesh, where we had performed well in the past and, led by Graeme Smith, we were again named among the favourites for the title.

As usual, the format of the quadrennial showpiece event was forgiving, with 14 teams divided into two round-robin groups of seven teams each – the top four in each group advancing to the quarterfinals. Some said the format had been designed to fill television schedules rather than fill anyone with excitement but, as a mere player, I could not possibly comment.

From the perspective of one of the main cricket nations, the event amounted to a period of four weeks' travelling around the subcontinent, knowing you probably needed only to defeat the two minor countries in your group and win one of the other four games to reach the knockout phase. Then, just like seven other teams, you would need to win three knockout matches to win the title and become 'world champions'.

Our campaign began with a hiccup when, during the ceremony before our opening match against the West Indies in Delhi, the playing of a recording of the South African national anthem was suddenly cut short, apparently by some technical fault. In a moment when many teams might have looked around, felt uncomfortable and even giggled, this Proteas team didn't miss a beat. We sang our anthem through to the end.

The impromptu 'a cappella' demonstrated our spirit; one glance at our